

Week 3: System Administration and Cybersecurity Incident Response Plan

Deliverable 4 of 5

Programme	Tech Career Accelerator
Week	Week 3: System Administration and Cybersecurity
Date Range	1st - 5th June
Prepared by	Jodie S and Sisanda M
Document Version	1.0

Objective: Develop comprehensive security, backup, and risk management documentation.

1. Purpose

This incident response plan provides a structured process for identifying, reporting, containing, removing, recovering from, and learning from cybersecurity incidents.

2. Incident Response Roles

Role	Responsibility
Employees	Report suspicious activity immediately and avoid attempting unauthorised fixes.
IT Support / System Administrator	Investigate alerts, contain affected devices, restore services, and maintain incident records.
IT Manager / Security Lead	Coordinate response activities, make escalation decisions, and communicate with management.
Management	Support business decisions, approve major recovery actions, and communicate with stakeholders when required.

3. Response Process

Phase	Action Required
1. Detection	Identify suspicious activity through antivirus alerts, user reports, unusual login attempts, system monitoring, performance issues, or security notifications.
2. Reporting	Employees must report incidents to IT or management immediately. Reports should include what happened, when it happened, affected systems, and any suspicious emails or files.
3. Containment	Limit damage by disconnecting affected devices, disabling compromised accounts, blocking malicious traffic, or isolating impacted systems.
4. Eradication	Remove the threat by deleting malware, patching vulnerabilities, resetting passwords, removing unauthorised access, and confirming systems are clean.
5. Recovery	Restore systems from clean backups, monitor for recurring issues, validate normal operations, and return services in priority order.
6. Lessons learned	Review the incident, document root cause, update policies, improve training, and apply technical controls to

Phase	Action Required
	prevent similar incidents.

4. Incident Severity Levels

Severity	Description	Example
Low	Limited impact and no confirmed data loss.	Single suspicious email reported and deleted.
Medium	Potential compromise affecting one user, device, or non-critical system.	Malware detected on one workstation.
High	Major business disruption, confirmed compromise, data exposure, or multiple systems affected.	Ransomware outbreak or compromised administrator account.

5. Communication Guidelines

- Communication must be clear, factual, and limited to verified information.
- Users must not post incident details publicly or share screenshots outside approved channels.
- Management must be informed of high-impact incidents as soon as possible.
- External communication should be approved by management and legal/compliance staff where applicable.

Approval and Review

This document should be reviewed at least annually and after any major security incident, infrastructure change, or business process change. Updates should be approved by the responsible IT or management representative.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Jodie S	Team member / Prepared by		
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	Reviewed by		
	Approved by		